

Leading the way

Managers should also take a positive approach to creative ideas rather than expecting employees to just do as they are told. Sharing your vision of the company's future, and how innovation contributes to that vision, will encourage employee participation. Managers should support and communicate with workers throughout the company rather than remaining distant, so that new ideas can originate at any level.

CREATING AN INNOVATIVE CLIMATE

FACTORS	HOW IT INFLUENCES INNOVATIVE BEHAVIOR
Motivation	• People are driven to make their mark on the world and motivated by the degree to which they feel able to do so. • Staff can be highly motivated by recognition of their contribution from both peers and superiors.
Availability of slack resources	• People need resources to experiment with. • They need time and space to explore and create.
Leadership	• People need role models who exemplify key values and who support innovation in actions as well as words. • They need leaders who consistently provide resources and motivation. • People value expressions of commitment at the strategic level.
Direction	• Innovation needs to be seen as strategically targeted and not just for the sake of it. • People will use measurement to drive improvement if they are motivated from within.
Self development	• It is important to help people continue to learn and acquire and use key skills.
Enabling tools and resources	• To contribute to the innovation task, people need training in systematic approaches to problem finding and solving.
Learning	• Learning helps people reflect on innovation experience. • It builds and extends understanding to guide action. • It encourages people to experiment. • Learning can be shared across the company.